

Polymarket

Prediction Markets · Sports Rights & Crypto-Native Trading · New York, New York · Private (\$21B; \$1B round, Aug 2026)

Polymarket, the prediction market that turns news and sport into tradeable odds, has a \$1B round at a \$21B valuation led by 1789 Capital, reported by Bloomberg on 31 August and 40% above April's \$15B price, and named its first CFO ten days later.

71

OPPORTUNITY / 100

TIMING WINDOW

HOT

SERIES

F1

RECOMMENDED TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team

ACTION HORIZON

6-10 WKS

THE CASE

Intercontinental Exchange committed up to \$2B in October 2025, making the owner of the New York Stock Exchange the distributor of Polymarket's event data; an April raise at \$15B then brought in DE Shaw and G Squared (reported). Volume crossed \$10B in a month for the first time in March 2026, and trading fees arrived on 30 March. Ari Borod, Fanatics' former chief business officer, joined in February as President of Sports Business Development; Warren Jenson, once Amazon's finance chief, became the first CFO on 10 September.

Rightsholders now sell this category on its own. MLB made Polymarket its exclusive prediction-market exchange in March, a deal reported at up to \$300M; the NHL took both Polymarket and Kalshi; the Yankees and Rangers signed at club level; Kalshi became the US Open's prediction-market partner on 31 August. Formula 1 sold betting-operator rights to Betway and FanDuel this year and left prediction markets unsold.

WHY NOW

The money landed on 31 August and the first CFO on 10 September; the NFL season and the November midterms are the volume events the marketing rebuild was hired for. Teams close 2027 rosters in the fourth quarter, and the United States GP in Austin in late October is the announcement stage.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

\$1B

\$1B round at a \$21B post-money valuation led by 1789 Capital, reported by Bloomberg on 31 Aug 2026, with 17...

\$15B

DE Shaw and G Squared joined in the April 2026 raise at \$15B (reported); 1789 Capital led the Aug 2026 roun...

\$2B

Intercontinental Exchange committed up to \$2B in October 2025, making the owner of the New York Stock Excha...

\$10B

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\$300M

MLB made Polymarket its exclusive prediction-market exchange in March, a deal reported at up to \$300M;

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (SPONSOR TABLE; 78 OF 346 PARTNER ROWS CATEGORISED)

Cadillac F1 Team	PRIME LANE	greenfield entry — partner roster being built from zero
McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	TAKEN	Allwyn, FxPro, Gemini
Aston Martin Aramco F1 Team	TAKEN	Circle, CoinPayments, Coinbase
Atlassian Williams Racing	TAKEN	Betway, Jackpot City Casino, Kraken

BOTTOM LINE

\$1B at \$21B, a first CFO, a sports-rights buyer that took MLB, the NHL and the Yankees inside a year, and a grid that sold betting twice and prediction markets never, with one clean American roster. Politics, regulators and a halo-only workstream hold it at 71; brand fit is under the engine's 12-point gate, so the desk ranks it 62. Built on request.

WHY CADILLAC F1 TEAM

Cadillac F1 Team is the one roster with no betting, casino, exchange or trading brand: Williams carries Betway and Jackpot City, Alpine Modo Casino, McLaren OKX and Allwyn, Aston Martin Coinbase and Public. Its owner group, TWG Global, also controls the Los Angeles Dodgers, whose league made Polymarket its exclusive exchange. American, debut season, and a stated preference for fewer, bigger partners.

VALUE TO CADILLAC F1 TEAM — MODE B (TECH SERVES THE TEAM OPERATION)

MODE B, halo with mechanics. Polymarket's Formula 1 markets (race winner, pole, fastest lap, safety car) become a free-to-play Cadillac predictions game in the team app and market-implied win probabilities in race-week content. Commercially: a \$21B partner at the reported premium tier, a young US audience, Austin and Miami hospitality. Nothing reaches the car.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Entry as Official Prediction Market Partner. **THREE YEARS**, 2027-2029, running through the 2028 US election, historically its peak-volume event. Estimated \$15-25M a year against a reported premium tier of \$20-30M. Scope: livery and garage placement, the predictions game, Austin and Miami hospitality. Las Vegas excluded until Nevada lifts its injunction.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Ari Borod

PRESIDENT OF SPORTS BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT, POLYMARKET ·
VERIFIED

Borod runs Polymarket's sports partnerships, joining in February 2026 from Fanatics, where he was chief business officer. Path: Travis VanderZanden, Chief Growth Officer (marketing); Warren Jenson, Chief Financial Officer; Shayne Coplan, founder and Chief Executive Officer.

OPENING ANGLE

Lead with the category, not the car.

“Ari, you took MLB and the Yankees this season. Formula 1 sold its betting rights and left prediction markets unsold; one clean American roster is being built for 2027. 25 minutes before Austin?”

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING 18 / 20 Round 31 Aug; first CFO 10 Sep; Austin inside the window.	CAPACITY 18 / 20 \$1B raised at \$21B; ICE up to \$2B; fees only since March.	BRAND FIT 11 / 20 Young US live-sport audience; gambling-adjacent, political, Nevada out.	URGENCY 15 / 20 NFL and midterm volume, US build-out, Kalshi taking rightsholders.	OPS FIT 9 / 20 MODE B: fan-engagement halo; nothing for the car.
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RISKS & COUNTERS

THE OWNER AND THE INVESTOR TWG Global's Mark Walter is under a DOJ and SEC investigation he denies; 1789 Capital, co-founded by Donald Trump Jr., leads the round while a House Oversight insider-trading probe is open. **Counter:** Put both on the table in the first call and contract reputational exit rights both ways.

REGULATORS AND THE CATEGORY Polymarket US is enjoined in Nevada with cease-and-desists in four more states, and F1 holds Betway and FanDuel as Official Betting Operators: is a prediction market a separable category? **Counter:** F1's betting deals are regional and non-exclusive; MLB and the NHL run both categories side by side. Clear the definition with Cadillac's counsel first.

SOURCES — 16 OF 16 LOAD-BEARING CLAIMS VERIFIED

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